

Meridian Valley General Hospital

Education & Staff Development Department New Employee Orientation & Continuing Education Handbook

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Status: Active | This is a fictional/demo document for RAG testing purposes.

1. Purpose and Scope

This handbook governs orientation, mandatory training, competency validation, and continuing education (CE) requirements for all clinical and non-clinical staff of Meridian Valley General Hospital. It applies to employees, contracted staff, students, and volunteers.

2. New Employee Orientation Program

2.1 Orientation Schedule

All new hires complete a mandatory 3-day General Orientation within their first week of employment, followed by department-specific orientation lasting 2-10 days depending on role complexity.

Day	Session	Duration	Location
Day 1	Hospital Mission, Values & Org Structure	2 hrs	Education Center Rm 101
Day 1	HR Policies, Payroll & Benefits Enrollment	2 hrs	Education Center Rm 101
Day 1	Compliance & Corporate Ethics (HIPAA, Fraud/Abuse)	3 hrs	Education Center Rm 101
Day 2	Infection Prevention & Control (IPC) Basics	2 hrs	Education Center Rm 102
Day 2	Fire, Life Safety & Emergency Codes (Code Red/Blue)	2 hrs	Education Center Rm 102
Day 2	Patient Safety, Just Culture & Incident Reporting	2 hrs	Education Center Rm 102
Day 3	Electronic Health Record (EHR) System Basics	4 hrs	IT Training Lab, Bldg B
Day 3	Body Mechanics & Workplace Safety	1.5 hrs	Education Center Rm 101

2.2 Department-Specific Orientation

Following General Orientation, employees report to their assigned unit for preceptor-guided orientation. Clinical staff must complete unit-specific skills checklists before working independent shifts. Preceptors document competency sign-off in the Learning Management System (LMS).

3. Mandatory Annual Training (All Staff)

- HIPAA Privacy & Security Refresher (30 min, LMS module EDU-101)
- Fire and Life Safety / RACE-PASS Fire Extinguisher Review (30 min)
- Bloodborne Pathogens Exposure Control (30 min, required for roles with exposure risk)

- Workplace Violence Prevention & De-escalation (45 min)
- Cultural Competency and Health Equity (30 min)
- Corporate Compliance and Anti-Kickback / Stark Law Overview (30 min)
- Emergency Preparedness: Hospital Incident Command System (HICS) Overview (30 min)

Completion deadline: all modules must be finished by the employee's hire-date anniversary each year.

Non-completion beyond a 30-day grace period results in automatic LMS escalation to the employee's manager and, if unresolved after 60 days, restriction of EHR access pending completion.

4. Clinical Competency Validation

4.1 Skills Requiring Annual Re-Validation

Competency	Applicable Roles	Method
BLS (Basic Life Support)	All clinical staff	AHA card, hands-on skills check
ACLS (Advanced Cardiac Life Support)	RN (ICU/ED/Tele), MD, RT	AHA card, simulation lab
PALS (Pediatric Advanced Life Support)	RN/MD in Pediatrics, ED, NICU	AHA card, simulation lab
IV Insertion & Central Line Care	RN (Med-Surg and above)	Skills lab + preceptor sign-off
Restraint & Seclusion Use	RN, Behavioral Health techs	Online module + skills demo
Moderate Sedation Monitoring	RN (Endoscopy, Radiology, ED)	Written exam + proctored case
High-Alert Medication Administration	RN, Pharmacist	Annual competency exam (80% pass)

5. Continuing Education (CE) Support

- Nursing staff: 20 CE hours/year required for license renewal; hospital reimburses up to \$750/year for approved external courses or conferences.
- Physicians: CME tracked via Medical Staff Office; minimum 50 CME credits per 2-year privileging cycle.
- Allied health (RT, PT, OT, Pharmacy): CE requirements per state licensing board, tracked in LMS.
- Internal Grand Rounds held every Thursday 12:00-1:00 PM in the Auditorium; 1 CE credit per session.
- Tuition assistance program: up to \$5,250/year for degree programs relevant to current or planned role, requires 1-year service commitment post-completion.

6. Simulation Center

The Clinical Simulation Center (Building C, 2nd Floor) offers high-fidelity manikin labs, a mock patient room, and a task-trainer library for procedural skills (suturing, intubation, central line placement, lumbar puncture). Units may book the center via the Education Department scheduling portal. Interprofessional simulation (rapid response, code blue, mass casualty drills) is run quarterly for each inpatient unit.

7. Learning Management System (LMS) Access

All staff access the LMS at learn.meridianvalley-demo.org using their network credentials. Managers can pull completion reports for their teams under Reports > Compliance Dashboard. Questions about assigned modules should be directed to education@meridianvalley-demo.org or extension 4420.

8. Contact

Education & Staff Development Department, Building C, 2nd Floor | Phone: ext. 4420 | Email: education@meridianvalley-demo.org | Hours: Mon-Fri, 7:00 AM - 5:00 PM